

Debate Example

Topic: Dogs are better pets than cats.



1st speech

Affirmative

Good (morning/afternoon) everyone. Today's debate topic is "dogs are better pets than cats." We agree that "dogs are better pets than cats." We have two reasons.

Our first reason is that dogs are smarter than cats. You can teach a dog many tricks. For example, sit, lay down, roll over, and many more. This is impossible with cats. My friend Takeshi has a Corgie called Fluffy. Takeshi was able to teach Fluffy 10 tricks in one week. Also, you can train dogs to do many useful things. Dogs can help blind people, rescue people in disasters, and look for dangerous things at the airport.

Negative

Good (morning/afternoon) everyone. Today's debate topic is "dogs are better pets than cats." We disagree that "dogs are better pets than cats." We have two reasons.

Our first reason is that cats are cleaner than dogs. Everybody knows that cats clean themselves all the time. They always lick themselves to take a bath. Dogs can't do this. You don't have to give cats a bath. Also, cats don't stink like dogs. Last week, I went to a dog shelter to look at puppies and kittens. I could not stay for long because it smelled really bad.

2nd speech

Affirmative

Our second reason is that dogs are friendlier than cats. A dog owner can become good friends with their dog. The dog is excited to see the owner when they come home from work or school. I have a cat. My cat does not care when I come home from school. Also, dogs can make owners happy and make them better people.

[According to a survey by the newspaper Furry Friends, 70% of dog owners said they became happier when they got a dog. Also, 65% of dog owners said they became better people when they got a dog.]

For these two reasons, we strongly agree that "dogs are better pets than cats." Thank you very much.

Negative

Our second reason is that cats are easier to take care of than dogs. They don't need the owner's help with everything like dogs do. You don't have to walk them. You don't have to give them a bath. Also, cats are better pets because you don't have to use a lot of time on them.

[According to busypeople.com, 80% of Japanese adults are too busy to have any free time. Therefore, if you are busy and want a pet, a cat is the best option.]

For these two reasons, we strongly disagree that "dogs are better pets than cats." Thank you very much.

Rebuttal

Affirmative

The other team said that cats are cleaner than dogs. However, I don't think so. It's true that dogs can't clean themselves. But this doesn't mean that cats are always cleaner. Sometimes cats still need baths. Also, the smell in dog shelters is not important.

The other team said that cats are easier to take care of than dogs. However I don't think so. Cats don't need their owner's help with everything, but they still need a lot of attention. My friend Timmy has a cat and it always causes trouble when he does homework on the computer.

[Last, we don't understand the statistics about busy people. What age are these people? Are they students or workers? There's not enough information.]

In summary, "dogs are better pets than cats." Thank you very much.

Negative

The other team said that you can't teach cats tricks. However, I don't think so. This is not true. Even though cats take more time, if you are patient, you can teach a cat tricks. Also, cats have good uses too. They can be used to comfort people and they can catch mice inside a house.

The other team also said that dogs are friendlier than cats. This is not always true. This depends on the cat. My friend Natalie's cat is friendly. It always wants me to pet it.

[According to website felinefriends.com, 70% of cat owners became happy when they got a kitten. Therefore, cats are as friendly as dogs.]

In summary, "dogs are not better pets than cats." Thank you very much.

End of debate